LabTrack Installation and Configuration

Applicable from version: LabTrack v0.3.0

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Reviewed against LabTrack v0.3.0.1

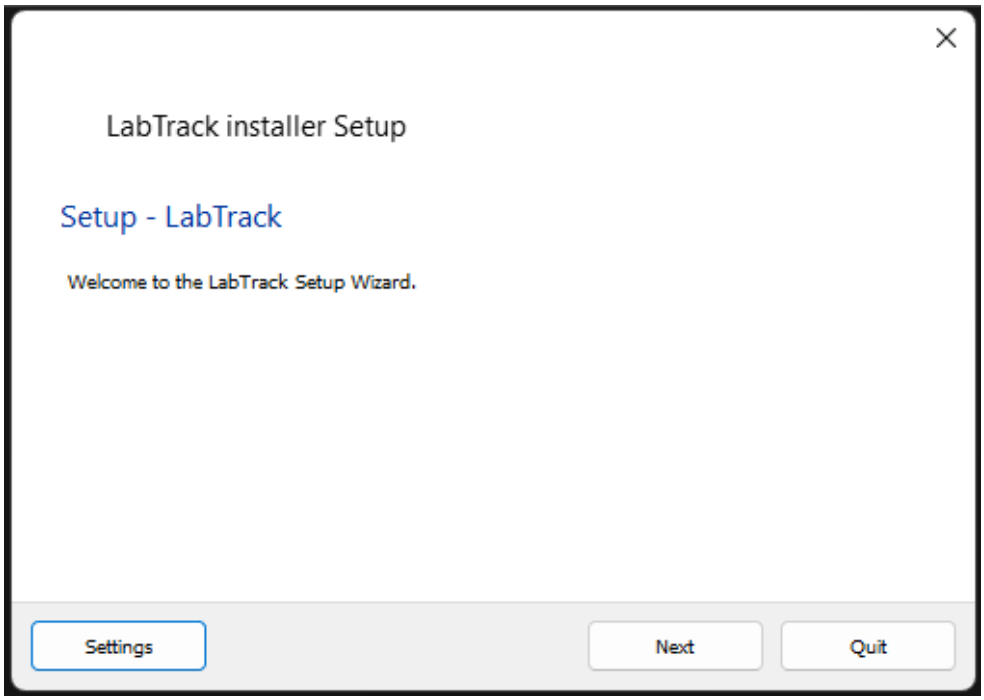
Supported Platforms

- Windows 10 / Windows 11
- Administrator privileges required for installation

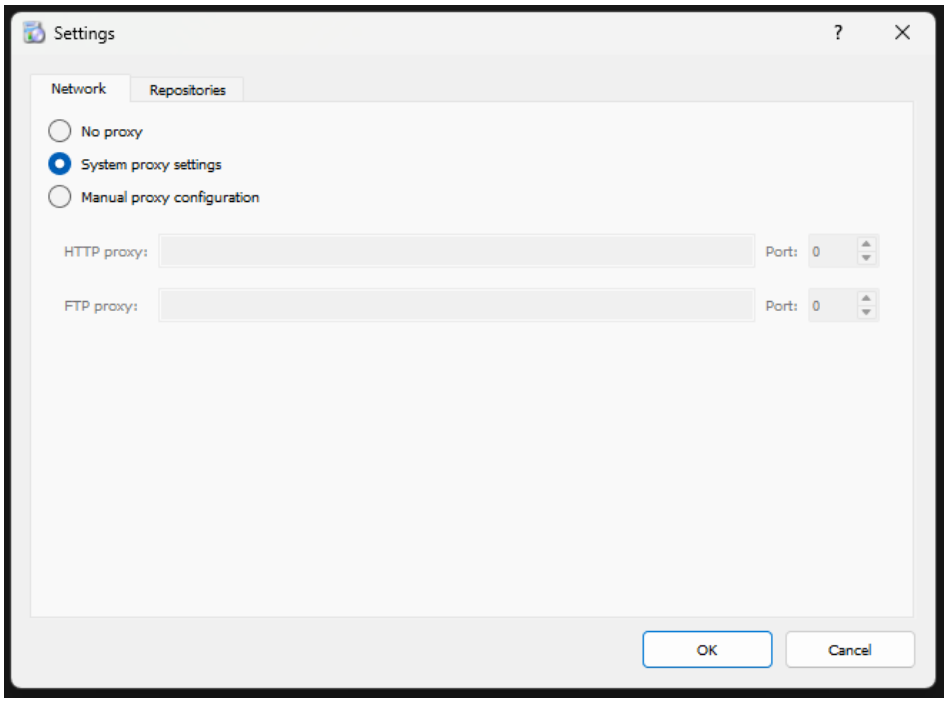
LabTrack interactive install 2
LabTrack configuration 5
Settings reference 7
Admin access 7
LabTrack interactive uninstall 8
Resetting LabTrack app configuration on Windows 10
LabTrack silent install and uninstall 11
Overview 11
Installation mode and uninstallation mode are independent 11
Silent installation 11
Silent uninstallation 12
Troubleshooting 12
Version history 13

LabTrack interactive install

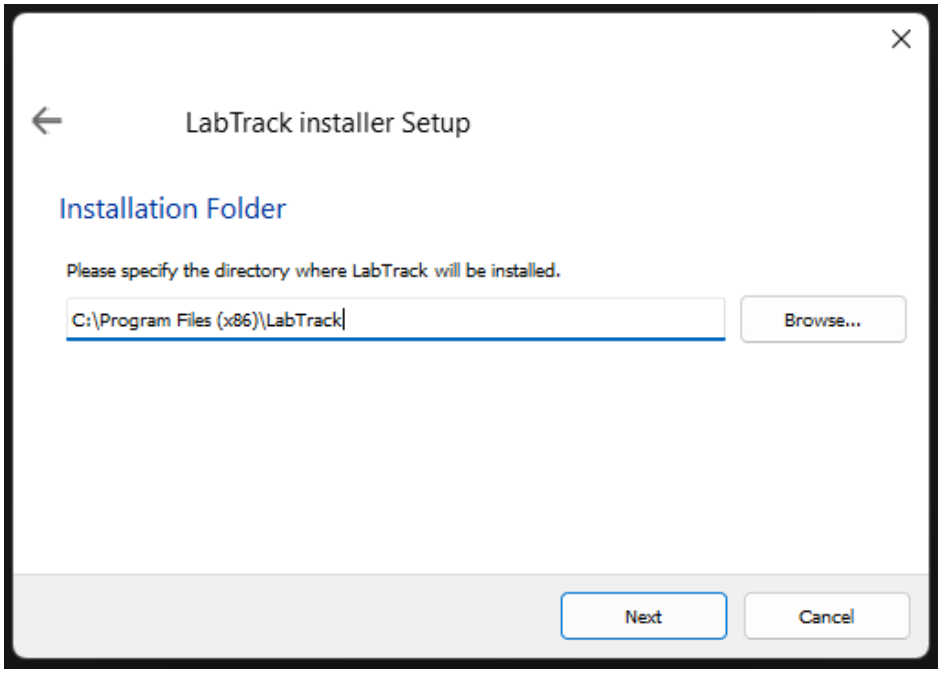
1. Double-click the installer provided by Calira, for example LabTrack_v0.3.0.1.exe, and accept the Windows permission prompt when it appears.



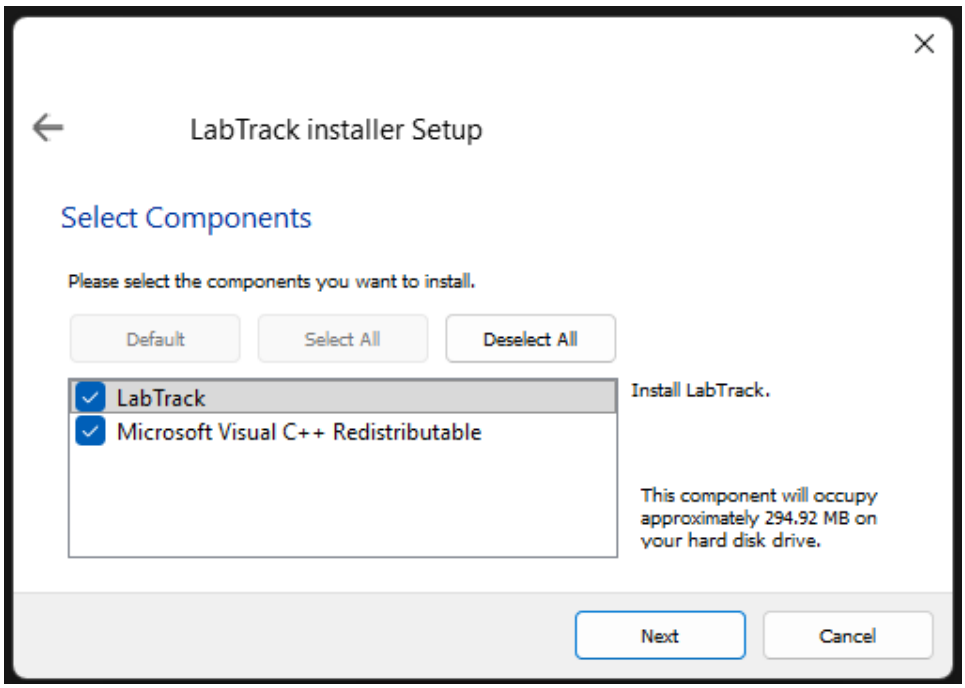
2. Optional: select **Settings** in the bottom left corner to configure a network proxy.



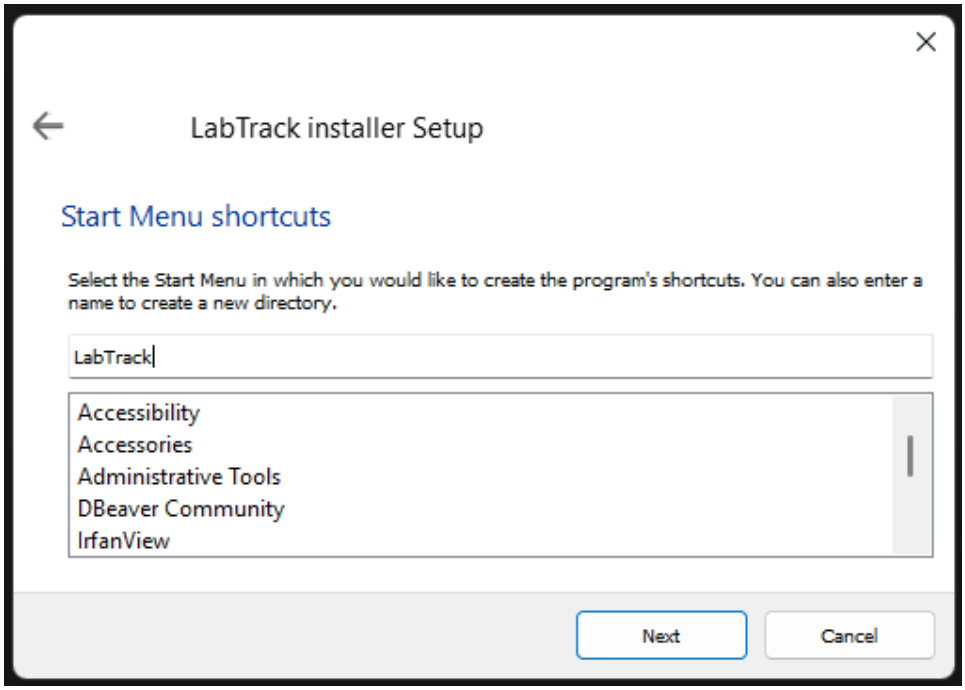
3. Select **Next**, then choose an installation path. Accept the default unless your IT department has told you otherwise.



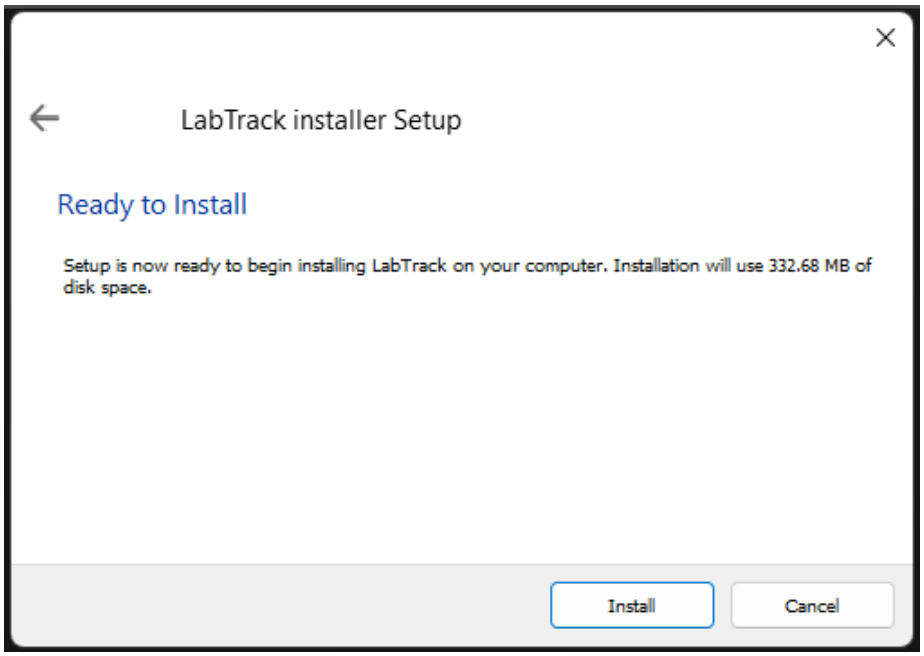
4. Select **Next** and choose the components to install. Install all components unless you have been told otherwise.



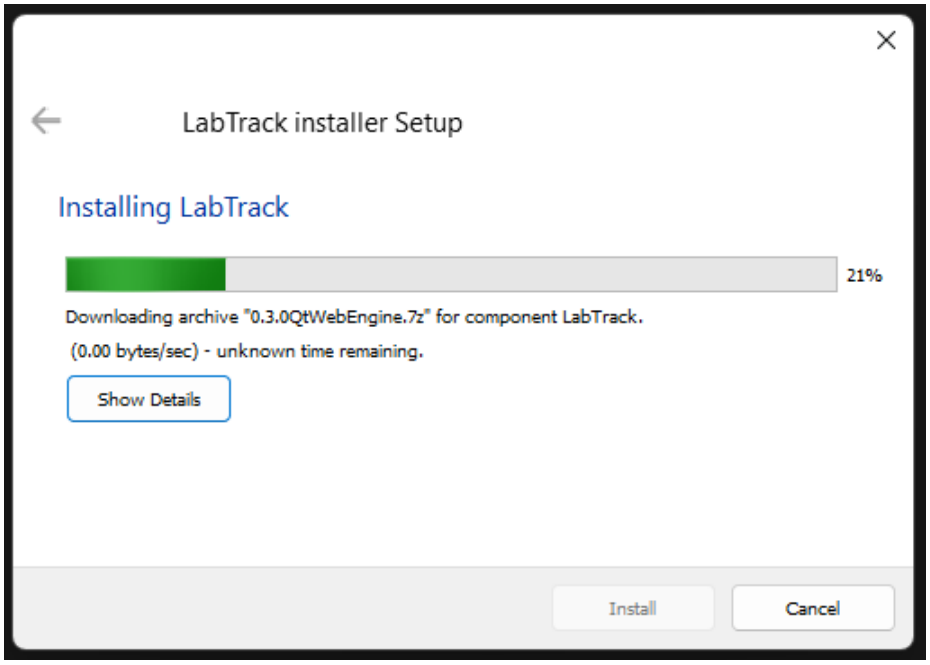
5. Select **Next**. You can rename the Start menu entry, but this is not recommended because the entry will then no longer match the application name.



6. Select **Next**, then **Install**.



7. Accept the Windows prompt to grant permission to install the application. The installation then runs.



If pop-ups flash up and disappear
This is usually a conflict with an existing Microsoft Visual C++ installation. Cancel the install, run it again and clear the option to install Microsoft Visual C++.

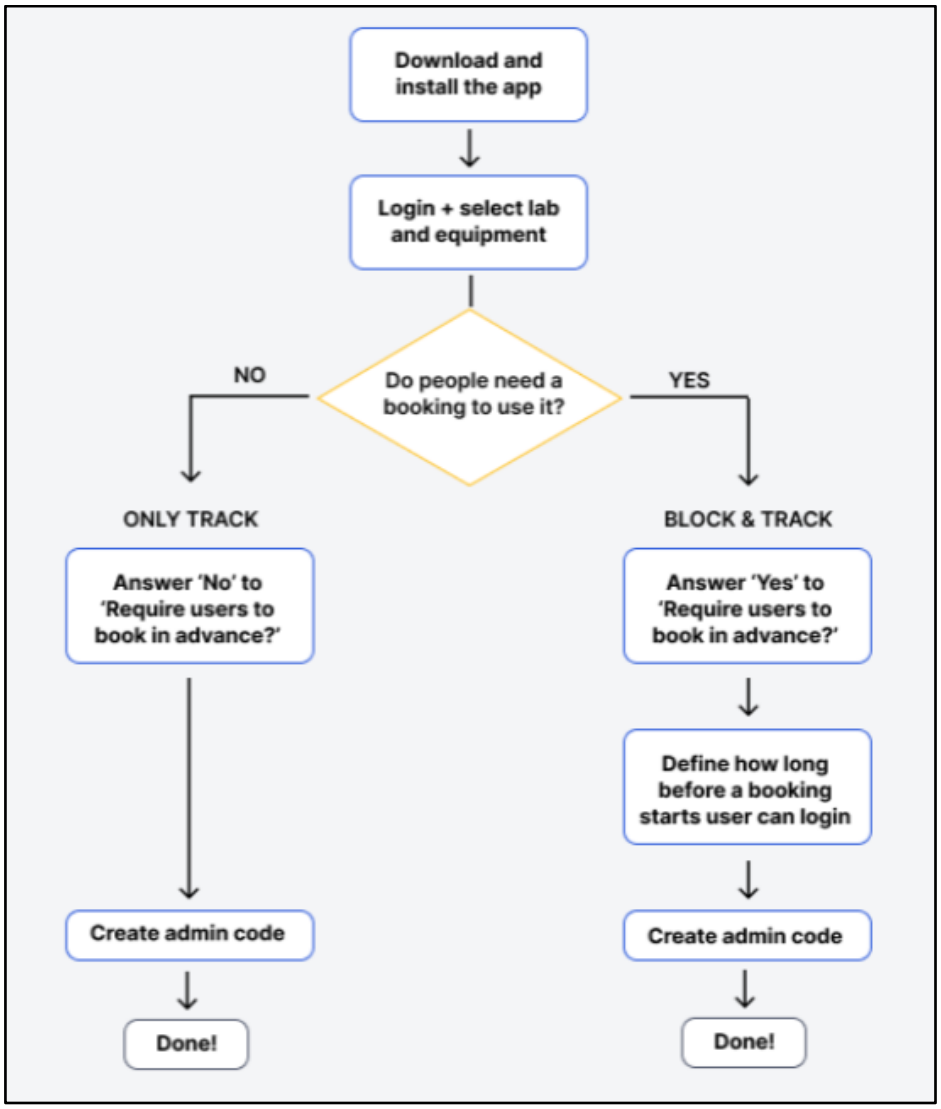
LabTrack configuration

Log in as a Calira lab admin the first time LabTrack starts to set up the PC for its equipment. Settings are stored for the whole PC, so Windows asks for permission each time you save them. Accept the prompt.

LabTrack can be used with two basic approaches:

1. Users require a booking to view the Windows desktop for the PC connected to the equipment. This enforces booking compliance and allows for comparing booked versus actual utilization.
2. Users do not require a booking to view the Windows desktop for the PC connected to the equipment. This only supports actual utilization.

The steps to configure these two approaches are summarized in the diagram below.



These steps are summarized in more detail in the table below:

Step Number	Enforce Bookings Step	Don't Enforce Steps
1	Log In	Log In
2	Select your lab	Select your lab
3	Select the connected equipment	Select the connected equipment
4	Set launch on startup (usually yes)	Set launch on startup (usually yes)
5	Select yes for "Require users to book in advance"	Select no for "Require users to book in advance"
6	Set how much earlier than a booking a user can log in.	Decide whether to use a default session length when there is no booking.
7	Set whether the LabTrack session should auto-end when the booking ends.	If using a default session length then set the length for the default.

8	If you selected auto-end sessions then choose how long after the booking ends the LabTrack session ends.	

Settings reference

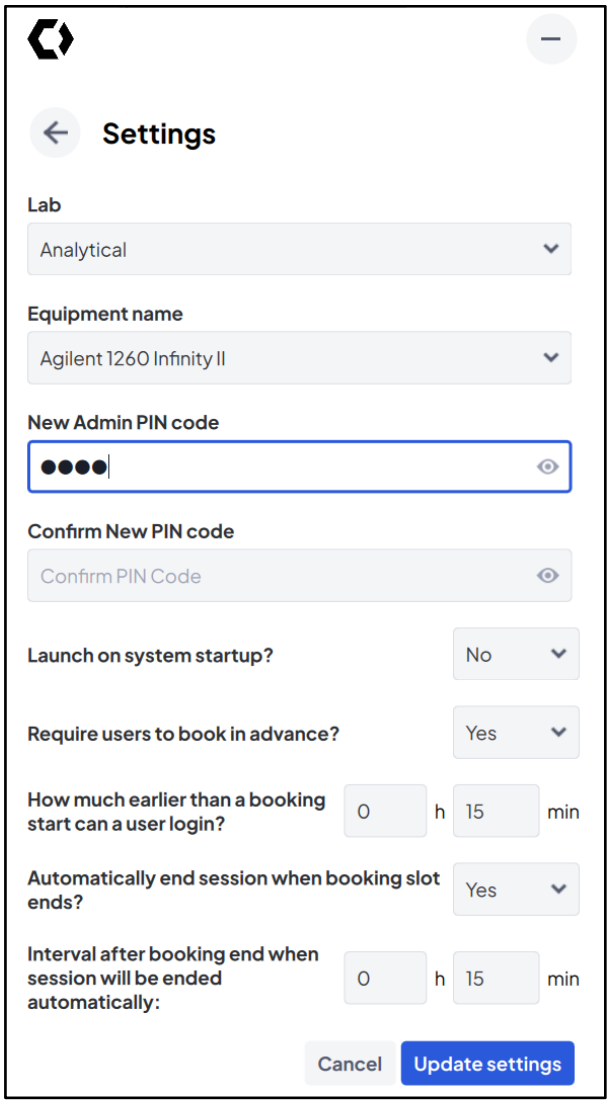
Defaults are those in LabTrack v0.3.0.1. The researcher column explains what each setting changes for people using the PC. Researchers can read the LabTrack user guide for researchers for the full picture.

Setting	What it does for researchers	Default
Launch on system startup	LabTrack starts when Windows starts and locks the PC. Choose Yes for any PC that should always be locked.	Set during setup. Usually Yes.
Require users to book in advance	Yes: researchers need a confirmed booking of their own to unlock the PC. No: anyone can log in and LabTrack records the session without a booking.	Yes
How much earlier than a booking start can a user log in	How many minutes before a booking starts researchers can unlock the PC. Their actual start time is recorded at log in.	15 minutes
Automatically end session when booking slot ends	LabTrack ends the researcher's session after the booking finishes, so unattended sessions do not run on. Lab admins are never ended automatically.	Yes
Interval after booking end	How long after the booking ends the session is ended. Researchers get a warning 5 minutes before and can delay the end.	15 minutes
Use default session length (no booking required)	Ends sessions with no booking after a fixed time. Only shown when bookings are not required.	Set during setup. Yes when bookings are not required.
Default session length without a booking	How long a session without a booking lasts before it is ended automatically.	60 minutes

Admin access

Lab admins can always unlock the PC, with or without a booking, and are not ended automatically. To get to the Windows desktop without logging in, select **Bypass with**

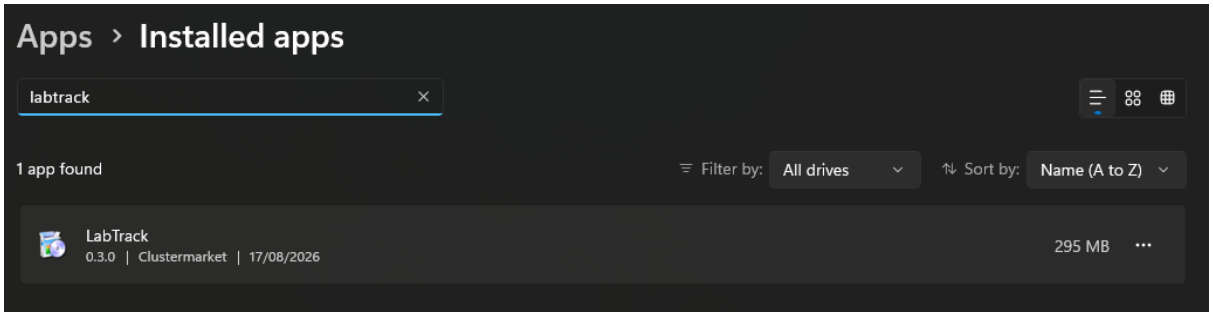
admin code on the log-in screen and enter the admin PIN. The PIN is stored on the PC. To set or change it, log in as a lab admin and click the config icon (cog wheel). Other users are returned to the LabTrack log-in screen if they try to leave it.



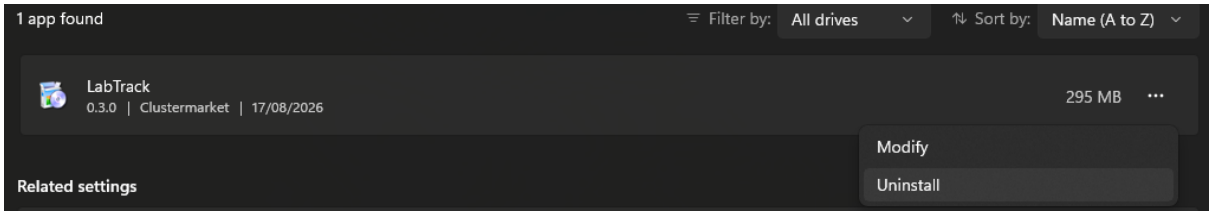
LabTrack interactive uninstall

Uninstalling LabTrack works the same way as for any Windows program.

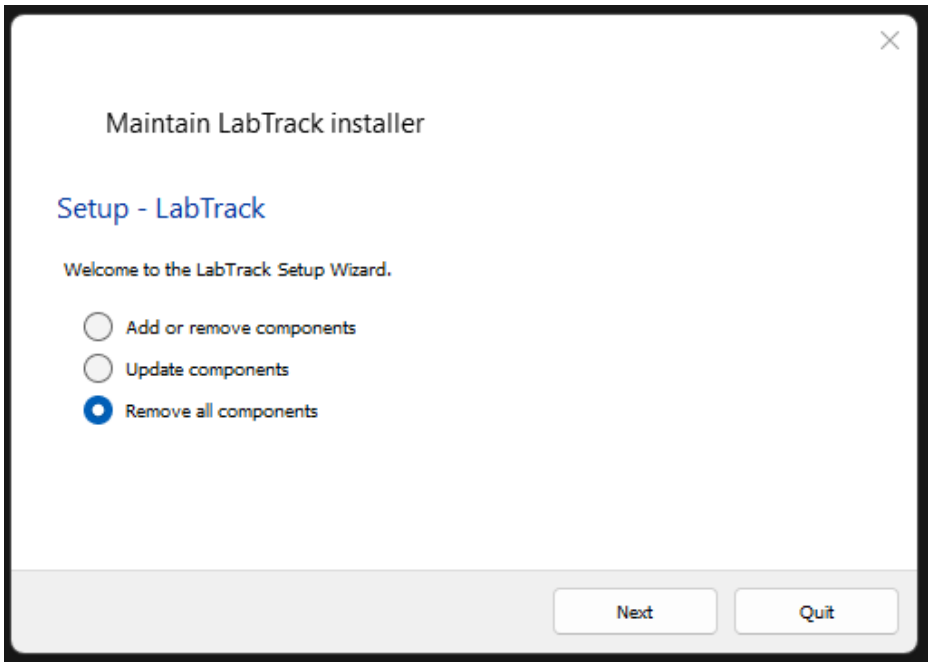
1. Open the Start menu, type “program” and select **Add or remove programs**. The installed apps list opens.



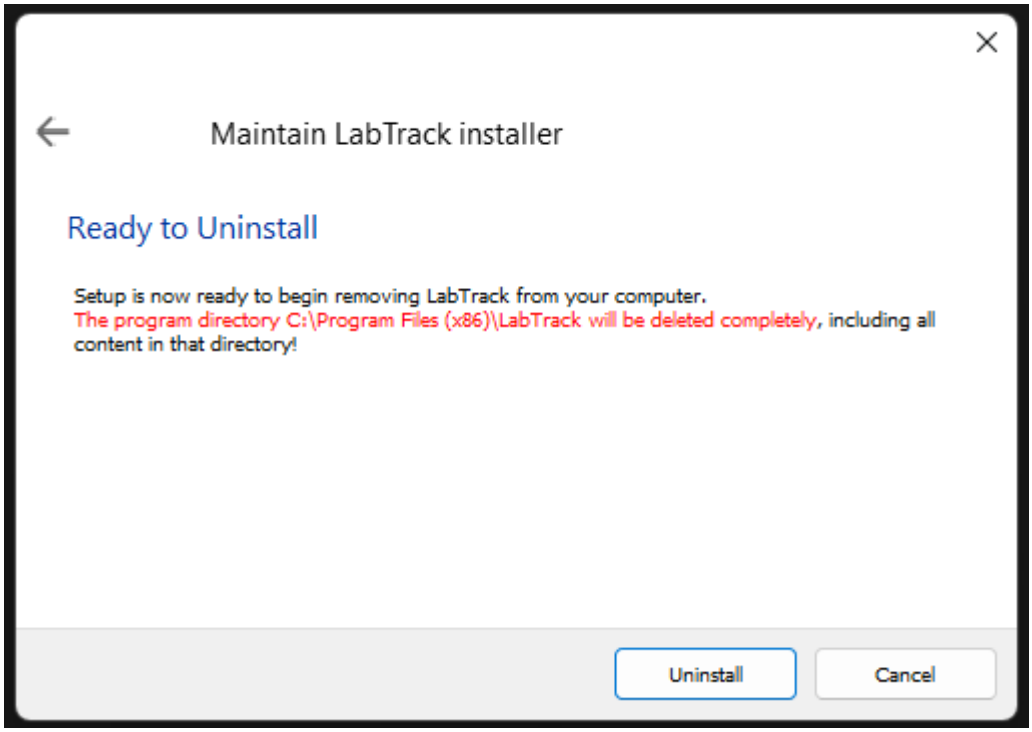
2. Type “labtrack” in the search box at the top of the list.
3. Select the ellipsis (“...”) on the LabTrack row and choose **Uninstall**.



4. The uninstaller opens. It gives you the option to remove all components.



5. Select **Next**, then **Uninstall**.



Uninstalling does not remove LabTrack's settings. If you need a full reset, follow the steps below.

Resetting LabTrack app configuration on Windows

Use this reset if you see unexpected errors during installation or uninstallation that may come from an earlier installation, or when a PC needs to be set up for different equipment.

LabTrack keeps its settings in the Windows registry, so they stay after you uninstall. They include the lab and equipment the PC is set up for, the booking rules and the admin PIN. A reset removes all of them. A lab admin must then set the PC up again.

Registry location	What it holds
HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Clustermarket\LabTrack	Current settings: lab, equipment, booking rules and admin PIN. On 64-bit Windows, also check HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\WOW6432Node\Clustermarket\LabTrack.
HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Clustermarket\LabTrack	Settings from older versions. LabTrack copies them to the machine settings on first start if the machine settings are empty, so delete this key too.
HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run, value LabTrack	The start-up entry created by “Launch on system startup”.

1. Uninstall LabTrack using the steps above.
2. Press **Win + R**, type **regedit** and select **OK**. Select **Yes** when Windows asks for permission.
3. Go to **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Clustermarket**. Right-click the **LabTrack** key and select **Delete**. If there is no LabTrack key, continue.
4. Go to **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Clustermarket**. Right-click the **LabTrack** key and select **Delete**. Delete only the LabTrack key, not the Clustermarket key above it. Repeat under **WOW6432Node** if a LabTrack key exists there.
5. Optional: if the PC was set to launch LabTrack on startup, go to **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run** and delete the **LabTrack** value.
6. Restart the PC, reinstall LabTrack and log in as a lab admin to set the PC up again.

Warning
Be careful when changing the registry. Incorrect changes can harm your system. Export a backup of the registry before you start.

LabTrack silent install and uninstall

Overview

From LabTrack v0.3.0, LabTrack supports both silent and interactive installation and uninstallation.

> **Important**
> Silent behaviour is not automatic.
> Silent mode is enabled only when you provide the matching command-line flag. Without the flag, the installer or uninstaller always runs in interactive mode.

Installation mode and uninstallation mode are independent

The way you installed LabTrack does not decide how you can uninstall it. All four combinations work.

Installed	Can be uninstalled
Silently	Interactively or silently
Interactively	Interactively or silently

Silent installation

The silent install installs LabTrack without showing any interface or asking for input. Run it from Windows PowerShell, as an administrator, in the folder that contains the installer.

Command

```
.\LabTrack_v0.3.0.1.exe silent=1 --verbose
```

Use the file name of the installer Calira gave you.

Behaviour

- No installer interface is shown.
- The installer goes through all steps on its own.
- The installer handles previous versions.
- The installation completes in the background.
- The exit code shows success or failure.

Notes

- silent=1 must be provided. Without it the installer always opens its interface.
- --verbose is recommended for logging and troubleshooting.

Silent uninstallation

Silent uninstall is opt-in. It runs silently only when you provide the silentUninstall=1 flag. It works whichever way LabTrack was installed.

Command

Run from Windows PowerShell, as an administrator, in the LabTrack installation directory:

```
cd "C:\Program Files (x86)\LabTrack"
```

```
.\maintenancetool.exe --uninstall silentUninstall=1
```

The path shown is the default. If LabTrack was installed somewhere else, use that folder.

Common pitfalls

- Running the uninstall without silentUninstall=1 and expecting it to run silently.
- Running the command outside the LabTrack installation directory.
- Running without administrator privileges.

Troubleshooting

What you see	Likely cause	What to do
Pop-ups flash up and disappear during install	Conflict with an existing Microsoft Visual C++ installation.	Cancel, run the installer again and clear the Visual C++ option.
Errors during install or uninstall	Settings or files left by an earlier installation.	Follow “Resetting LabTrack app configuration on Windows”.
The silent install or uninstall shows a window	The silent flag is missing.	Add silent=1 to the install command or silentUninstall=1 to the uninstall command.
The silent uninstall does nothing	The command ran outside the installation directory, or without administrator rights.	Open PowerShell as an administrator and run the command from the LabTrack folder.
Windows asks for permission when you save settings	LabTrack stores its settings for the whole PC and needs administrator rights to do that.	Accept the prompt. If you decline, the settings are not saved.
LabTrack does not start with Windows	Launch on system startup was set to No, or the start-up entry was not written.	Log in as a lab admin, open settings, set Launch on system startup to Yes and save.

What you see	Likely cause	What to do
The set-up screen appears again	The PC has no saved settings, for example after a reset.	Log in as a lab admin and set the PC up again.
“Equipment deleted. Application reset required.”	The equipment was deleted in Calira.	Select Reset equipment and set the PC up again for the correct equipment.
“Update available”	A newer version of LabTrack exists.	Get the new installer from Calira and install it over the existing version. Researchers should select Cancel.
A researcher cannot unlock the PC	No confirmed booking of their own inside the unlock window.	Check the booking in Calira and the unlock window in settings. See the user guide for researchers.
An admin cannot remember the admin PIN	The PIN is stored on the PC and cannot be read back.	Log in as a lab admin, open settings from the config icon and set a new PIN.
Log in fails with a connection error	The PC cannot reach Calira.	Check the PC’s internet access and proxy settings with your IT department.

Version history

Version	Date	Changes
v0.2.9	To confirm	Auto log out now locks the primary monitor when LabTrack is minimised (LABTRACK-57).
v0.3.0	To confirm	Silent install and uninstall.
v0.3.0.1	To confirm	To confirm.